motives for the Emergency being imposed by Indira Gandhi or the experiments by Muhammad bin Tughlaq. Were their 'bold and audacious' actions driven by a genuine belief that these measures were good for the people or were these cynical political moves?

Irrespective of their motives, history tells us of the outcomes for these two former rulers.[3] It is too early to say how history will judge Prime Minister Modi's note ban, but in fairness, any policy measure should be judged against the objectives that it sets out to achieve.

In this context, the Prime Minister, in his 8 November speech, explicitly described the objectives of India's 2016 demonetization exercise. Over subsequent months, other objectives were added by the Finance Minister and senior officials of the MoF, subjecting the government to accusations of shifting goal-posts. Notwithstanding this criticism, there can be no doubt that many of the stated objectives were good ones – goals that most Indians believe are desirable, if our nation is to progress.

The question, however, is not if the goals were good ones, but if the demonetization exercise achieved the objectives that its architects had wished for.

What is the report card of this major step?

Though it is clear that demonetization caused great disruption and distress to millions of Indians and delivered a massive shock to the Indian economy, did it achieve any of its stated goals?

In order to be purely objective, factual data from Government of India sources is presented on each of the demonetization goals to enable the reader to arrive at a conclusion.

The Eight Big Goals of Demonetization

Prime Minister's three main goals: Black money, corruption and terrorism